

August 20, 2026

BlueCross BlueShield of South Carolina
Provider Appeals Department
P.O. Box 100300
Columbia, SC 29202

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Jerrell Gerlach (MRN MUSC3906137), Claim MUSC-D48A-2

Patient	Jerrell Gerlach (DOB 1939-01-27)
MRN	MUSC3906137
Member ID / Group	BCB447669083 / GRP-66199
Claim number	MUSC-D48A-2
Date of service	2026-06-23
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	J06.9 — Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified
Denied amount	\$537.47
Denial code	CARC 16 / RARC N290 — Claim/service lacks information or has submission/billing error(s).
Appeal deadline	2026-11-13

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health Florence Medical Center submits this formal reconsideration request on behalf of patient Jerrell Gerlach (MRN: MUSC3906137, Member ID: BCB447669083, Group: GRP-66199) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-D48A-2 for services rendered on June 23, 2026. The claim was denied on August 15, 2026, under CARC 16 / RARC N290, with the payer remark stating: "Claim cannot be adjudicated; required data element(s) are missing or invalid," citing a missing, incomplete, or invalid rendering provider primary identifier. MUSC Health respectfully disputes this denial and submits that the rendering provider's National Provider Identifier (NPI) was valid and on file at the time of submission. We request full adjudication and payment of this claim.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Mr. Gerlach is an 87-year-old male with an established and complex medical history managed at MUSC Health Florence Medical Center. His active conditions include anemia (D64.9), atrial fibrillation, carcinoma in situ of the prostate, and prediabetes, and he carries a long-standing medication regimen that includes Warfarin Sodium, Digoxin, Verapamil Hydrochloride, Leuprolide Acetate, and DOCEtaxel. On June 23, 2026, Mr. Gerlach was seen as an established outpatient by Robert K. Lindqvist, MD (NPI 1314059687) at MUSC Health Florence Medical Center, Place of Service 22. The encounter was billed as CPT 99214, an office or outpatient visit for an established patient of moderate complexity, with a primary diagnosis of acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified (J06.9), and a secondary diagnosis of anemia (D64.9). The total billed amount was \$537.47, against a payer-allowed amount of \$305.55. No payment was issued.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The sole stated basis for denial is RARC N290, indicating that the rendering provider's primary identifier — the NPI — was missing, incomplete, or invalid on the submitted claim. MUSC Health asserts that this characterization is inaccurate. Robert K. Lindqvist, MD holds NPI 1314059687, which is an active, valid Type 1 NPI registered in the National Plan and Provider Enumeration System (NPPES). This NPI was included on the original claim submission dated July 8, 2026. A billing error of this nature, if any discrepancy exists, constitutes a correctable administrative deficiency and does not reflect any question of medical necessity, coverage eligibility, or coding accuracy. CPT 99214 is an appropriate level of service for an established patient visit of moderate complexity given Mr. Gerlach's active, multifaceted conditions and ongoing medication management. The patient's coverage under BlueCross BlueShield of South Carolina Choice Plus was active on the date of service, with a coverage period extending through December 31, 2026. There is no clinical, contractual, or coding basis to deny payment for this encounter.

We are submitting this appeal through the My Insurance Manager (MIM) portal in accordance with the instructions provided on the remittance advice, and we are attaching the relevant remittance advice and supporting medical record documentation as directed.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that BlueCross BlueShield of South Carolina reprocess Claim MUSC-D48A-2 in full, recognizing NPI 1314059687 as a valid and active rendering provider identifier for Robert K. Lindqvist, MD, and issue payment at the allowed amount of \$305.55 in accordance with the terms of the BlueCross BlueShield of South Carolina Choice Plus plan. Should any additional documentation or corrected claim submission be required to resolve this administrative matter, we ask that the payer contact MUSC Health Revenue Cycle directly so that any outstanding requirement may be addressed promptly and without further delay to adjudication.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

Senior Appeals Specialist, Revenue Cycle Management
MUSC Health — Revenue Cycle / Patient Financial Services
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Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record